

COURT HEARING CHECKLIST

What to bring with you to your eviction hearing:

- ☐ This packet (your filed Answer and all supporting documents)
- ☐ Your lease or rental agreement
- ☐ Any rent receipts or proof of payment (bank statements, canceled checks)
- ☐ Photos or videos of any repair issues (if applicable)
- ☐ Any written communication with your landlord (emails, texts, letters)
- ☐ Your written repair notice sent to the landlord (if applicable)
- ☐ Proof of rental assistance application (if applicable)
- ☐ Photo ID
- ☐ A pen and paper for taking notes
- ☐ A list of the points you want to make to the judge
- ☐ Any witnesses (if applicable)
- ☐ Your phone (silenced) with important numbers saved

WHAT TO EXPECT AT THE HEARING:

- Arrive early. Find the right courtroom.
- When your case is called, step forward.
- Address the judge as 'Your Honor.'
- Stay calm. Speak clearly. Stick to the facts.
- The landlord (or their lawyer) will speak first.
- When it's your turn, explain your defense briefly.
- Show the judge any evidence you brought.
- The judge may ask questions — answer honestly.
- The judge will make a decision or set another hearing date.

IMPORTANT: This document is provided for informational purposes only. It is not legal advice. If you need legal advice, contact a licensed attorney.
You are responsible for your own case and what you say in court.